Mastering Git Cherry-Pick for Absolute Beginners

Git cherry-pick is a lifesaver when you need to grab a specific code fix without merging an entire branch. It helps you keep your deployments clean and targeted without unnecessary code changes.

What you'll learn:

1. Finding the Right Commit ID
2. Applying the Cherry-Pick
3. Resolving Merge Conflicts
4. Aborting a Messy Cherry-Pick

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Finding the Right Commit ID

Before you can copy a change, you need to know its address. The git log command shows a neat list of recent commits with their short hashes so you can easily identify the one you want to grab.

```
$git log --oneline -n 5
```

Git Cherry-Pick: Grab a Single Commit Without a Full Merge

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Applying the Cherry-Pick

Once you have the commit hash, switch to the branch where you want the fix to live. Run the cherry-pick command followed by that hash to copy the exact code changes over instantly.

```
$git checkout main
 git cherry-pick a1b2c3d
```

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Resolving Merge Conflicts

Sometimes the target branch has changed too much, causing a conflict. Git will pause the process, letting you open the file, fix the conflicting lines manually, stage the file, and resume.

```
$git add resolved_file.js
 git cherry-pick --continue
```

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Aborting a Messy Cherry-Pick

If a cherry-pick goes sideways and conflicts are too confusing, don't panic. You can completely cancel the operation and return your branch to the exact state it was in before you started.

```
$git cherry-pick --abort
```

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See Key Takeaways on next page >> linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

Key Takeaways

+ Always check your current branch using git status before running the command.
+ Use short commit hashes from git log --oneline to save typing time.
+ Communicate with your team if you are cherry-picking fixes across release branches.
+ Run tests immediately after a successful cherry-pick to ensure everything works.
+ Keep a clean working directory before starting any cherry-pick operation.

Watch Out For

! Forgetting to switch to the correct destination branch before running the command.
! Creating duplicate commit histories by cherry-picking the same code repeatedly.
! Ignoring merge conflict markers and pushing broken code to shared repositories.

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